

General Lit.





About the Course

Read living books full of memorable characters, surprising plot twists, and heartwarming endings. Due to the rise of Children's Literature in the 19th century, students read period literature rather than historical fiction this year and will spend about a term and a half each with *Little Women* and *Hans Brinker*.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grades 5-6

About Literature: Grades 5-6

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.



Placement & Combining Tips

About Literature: Grades 5-6

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

Easily combined with Grade 4.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-6	General Lit.: Grades 5-6 1 time/week 20 min	<i>Hans Brinker</i> or <i>The Silver Skates</i> <i>Little Women</i>

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grades 5-6				
Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6		General Lit.: Grades 5-6		



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

- ☐ With engaging and straightforward narrative, *King of the Wind* (Term 1) eases students into the year and is a great book for them to read independently and use for written narrations.
- ☐ Due to the length of the books, students will not finish *Johnny Tremain* (Term 2) or *Treasure Island* (Term 3) in the scheduled lessons. Encourage students to finish these books on their own time over Exam week or on breaks. Both are riveting stories and are great options to encourage a lifelong habit of reading outside of school.
- ☐ *Treasure Island* (Term 3) contains a few instances of racist and/or outdated language, and wine and rum appear regularly throughout the book. Some notes are added in the lessons, but you will want to decide how to discuss these realities with your students.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Lit.: Grades 5-6



Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates



Little Women



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



General Lit.: Grades 5-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students read independently. See Planning and Prep notes for recommendations.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, try showing an illustration, sharing something that you remember, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Keep an eye out for things to add to your Book of Centuries, Citizenship Notebook, and Copywork book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or

challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.

- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, legos, dolls, etc. to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time, can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

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Term 1	
WEEK 1	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 1
WEEK 2	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 2
WEEK 3	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 3
WEEK 4	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 4
WEEK 5	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 5
WEEK 6	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 6
WEEK 7	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 7
WEEK 8	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 8
WEEK 9	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 9
WEEK 10	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 10
WEEK 11	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 11
WEEK 12	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 12

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Term 2	
WEEK 1	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 13
WEEK 2	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 14
WEEK 3	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 15
WEEK 4	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 16
WEEK 5	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 17
WEEK 6	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 18
WEEK 7	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 19
WEEK 8	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 20
WEEK 9	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 21
WEEK 10	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 22
WEEK 11	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 23
WEEK 12	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 24

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Term 3	
WEEK 1	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 25
WEEK 2	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 26
WEEK 3	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 27
WEEK 4	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 28
WEEK 5	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 29
WEEK 6	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 30
WEEK 7	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 31
WEEK 8	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 32
WEEK 9	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 33
WEEK 10	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 34
WEEK 11	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 35
WEEK 12	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 36